

Solution #7: Try a standard diagnostic.

If all the above have been ruled out as causes of your problem, try the standard diagnostic at http://kb.mozillazine.org/Standard_diagnostic_%28Firefox%29.

► **Problem:** Firefox uses too much memory.

Comments: By default, Firefox does not use a fixed size memory cache. Setting a fixed size memory cache can reduce memory usage. The about:config window in Firefox lists many options you can change.

Solution: To set a fixed size memory cache, add the following preference in about:config (type in “about:config” in the address bar):

`browser.cache.memory.capacity`

This is an integer value, and can be set to the size you want the cache to be, in kilobytes.

To disable the memory cache entirely, set `browser.cache.memory.enable` to false. Note that this is not advised unless you’re extremely short of memory, as it can slow things down severely, as well as causing other odd behaviour.

There is also a preference that enables trimming Firefox memory usage when you minimise all Firefox windows. To enable it, set “`config.trim_on_minimize`” to “true” in about:config.

► **Problem:** Firefox takes longer than expected to go back and forward between pages or Firefox 1.5 is too slow when you use multiple tabs.

Comments: There is a preference in about:config that can fix this, depending on how much RAM you have.

Solution: Firefox 1.5 has a new fast back/forward feature that vast

ly reduces the amount of time taken to display pages when the back/forward buttons are used. This does add to memory usage, though. Set “`browser.sessionhistory.max_total_viewers`” to the